EXPLORATORY DATA ANALYSIS · PUBLIC DATA

Maldives Crime Statistics

A Three-Year Exploratory Analysis, 2024–2026

Recorded cases from the Maldives Police Service · 2026 partial year · Revised 1 November 2026

–4.2%

Total recorded cases, 2025 vs 2024 (12,641 → 12,113)

+23.7%

Drug cases, 2025 vs 2024 (1,670 → 2,066)

9–10 months

of 2026 data (last month not recorded): not comparable with full years

Summary

Recorded cases fell **4.2%** between 2024 and 2025, from 12,641 to 12,113. The 2026 figures cover only part of the year, probably nine to ten months, so the raw 2026 total of 10,205 cannot be compared with a full year. Converted to a monthly rate, the 2026 total is 1.1% to 12.3% above the 2025 rate, depending on the cutoff. Underneath the overall movement, two categories behave very differently from the rest.

- **Drugs is the one consistent increase.** Cases rose from 1,670 to 2,066 to 2,128 (2026, partial year). That is about 139 and 172 cases a month in 2024 and 2025, and 213 to 236 in 2026 depending on the cutoff. Drugs grew from 13.2% to 20.9% of all recorded cases.
- **Traffic accidents rose modestly in 2025; 2026 is unresolved.** 3,079 cases was the highest of the three annual counts, 6.8% above 2024. Whether the 2026 monthly rate is above or below 2025 depends on the cutoff month.
- **All ten other categories fell from 2024 to 2025.** In 2026, sexual offences, robbery and counterfeit and forgery (and cheque bounce, on very small counts) kept falling under either cutoff, while vandalism and assault rose above their 2025 rates under either cutoff.
- **These are recorded cases, not proof that crime itself changed.** The data cannot show whether either of the two laws discussed in this report affected the counts.

Data and approach

Objectives. (1) Describe how recorded cases changed between 2024 and 2026, overall and by category; (2) identify the categories with the largest changes; (3) state what the data can and cannot support.

The analysis uses annual counts for twelve categories from the Maldives Police Service crime statistics, for 2024, 2025 and 2026 (partial year). The source labels the figures “case counts” and says its data come from the police case reporting platform; the supplied files do not say whether they count reports received or cases attended, so this report uses “recorded cases”. 2024 and 2025 are treated as complete calendar

years (the files do not state this). The three yearly totals match the sum of the twelve categories, and no values are missing.

Because 2026 is not a full year, the analysis compares the two full years (2024 and 2025) directly and converts 2026 to **cases per month**. The exact last month of the 2026 data is not recorded: the source note says only “up to Oct”, and the spreadsheet was created on 25 October 2026, so a complete October is unlikely. Every 2026 comparison is therefore shown under two cutoffs, ten months (January–October) and nine months (January–September). Where the two disagree, the direction is described as not settled. No significance tests are used: the figures are complete tallies of recorded cases, and the report makes descriptive comparisons rather than inferences about an underlying process.

Traffic accidents and lost items appear to be incident or service reports rather than offences (the source does not define its categories). Together they make up 33.6% of 2025 cases, so the total is best read as “recorded cases”, not “crime”.

Results by category

Category	2024	2025	2026 (partial)	2025 vs 2024	Per month 2024	Per month 2025	2026 ÷ 10	2026 ÷ 9
Theft	3,762	3,480	2,814	−7.5%	313.5	290.0	281.4	312.7
Traffic Accidents	2,882	3,079	2,452	+6.8%	240.2	256.6	245.2	272.4
Drugs	1,670	2,066	2,128	+23.7%	139.2	172.2	212.8	236.4
Lost Items	1,036	993	819	−4.2%	86.3	82.8	81.9	91.0
Vandalism	714	603	558	−15.5%	59.5	50.3	55.8	62.0
Assault	662	596	540	−10.0%	55.2	49.7	54.0	60.0
Domestic Violence	657	356	269	−45.8%	54.8	29.7	26.9	29.9
Sexual Offences	506	323	225	−36.2%	42.2	26.9	22.5	25.0
Embezzlement	321	272	223	−15.3%	26.8	22.7	22.3	24.8
Robbery	257	232	122	−9.7%	21.4	19.3	12.2	13.6
Counterfeit and Forgery	167	107	53	−35.9%	13.9	8.9	5.3	5.9
Cheque Bounce	7	6	2	−14.3%	0.6	0.5	0.2	0.2
Total	**12,641**	**12,113**	**10,205**	**−4.2%**	**1,053.4**	**1,009.4**	**1,020.5**	**1,133.9**

Shaded cells: orange = increase, blue = decrease (2025 vs 2024). Per-month figures are annual cases ÷ 12 for 2024 and 2025, and 2026 cases ÷ 10 or ÷ 9 months because the last month of the 2026 data is not recorded. Percentage changes for cheque bounce (7, 6 and 2 cases) are not meaningful.

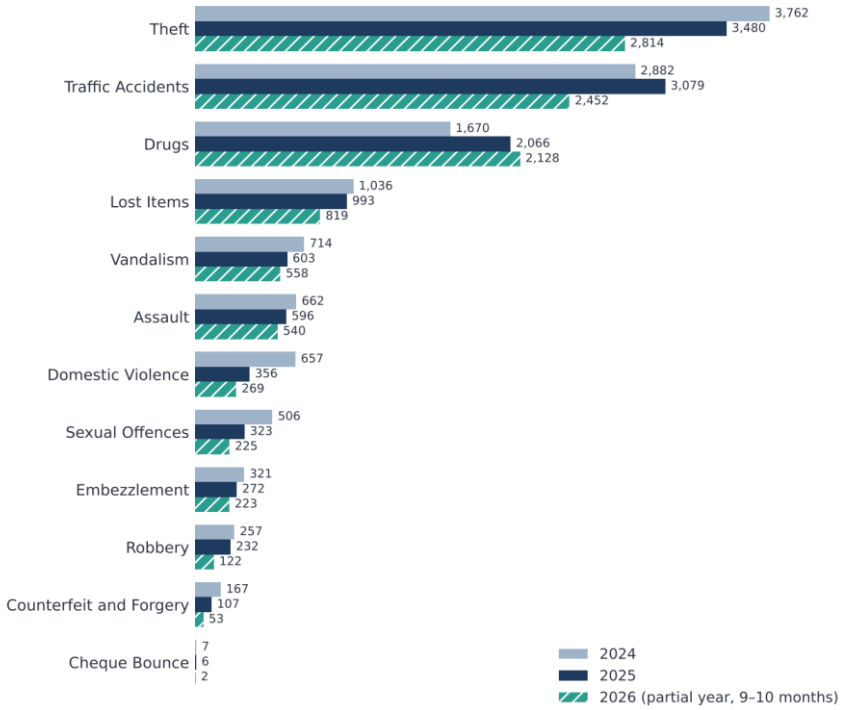


Figure 1. Recorded cases by category. 2026 (hatched) is a partial year of nine to ten months.

Key findings

1. Drugs: the one consistent increase

Observation Cases rose from 1,670 to 2,066 (+396, +23.7%, the largest absolute rise of any category) and reached 2,128 in the partial year 2026, already above the full-year 2025 count. Monthly cases went from 139 to 172, then to 213 (ten-month cutoff) or 236 (nine-month cutoff). The rise holds under both cutoffs.

Interpretation More drug cases were recorded. That could reflect more drug activity, more detection and enforcement (drug offences are often detected through police activity rather than reported by victims, a general point these data do not test), or changed recording or classification. The data cannot separate these.

> **What the data cannot show**
> There is no split by offence type (use, possession, trafficking) and no enforcement data. The continued rise after the Gang Act was ratified in May 2025 does not show the Act failed or succeeded.

2. Traffic accidents: a modest rise in 2025, 2026 unresolved

Observation Cases were 2,882, 3,079 and 2,452 (2026, partial year). The 2025 count is 197 cases (6.8%) above 2024, and its monthly rate of 257 is the highest of the two full years. The 2026 monthly rate is 245 on the ten-month cutoff and 272 on the nine-month cutoff.

Interpretation The 2025 rise is the second-smallest percentage change among the twelve categories. For 2026, the monthly rate is 4.4% lower than 2025 on the ten-month cutoff and 6.2% higher on the nine-month cutoff, so it is not known whether 2025 was a peak.

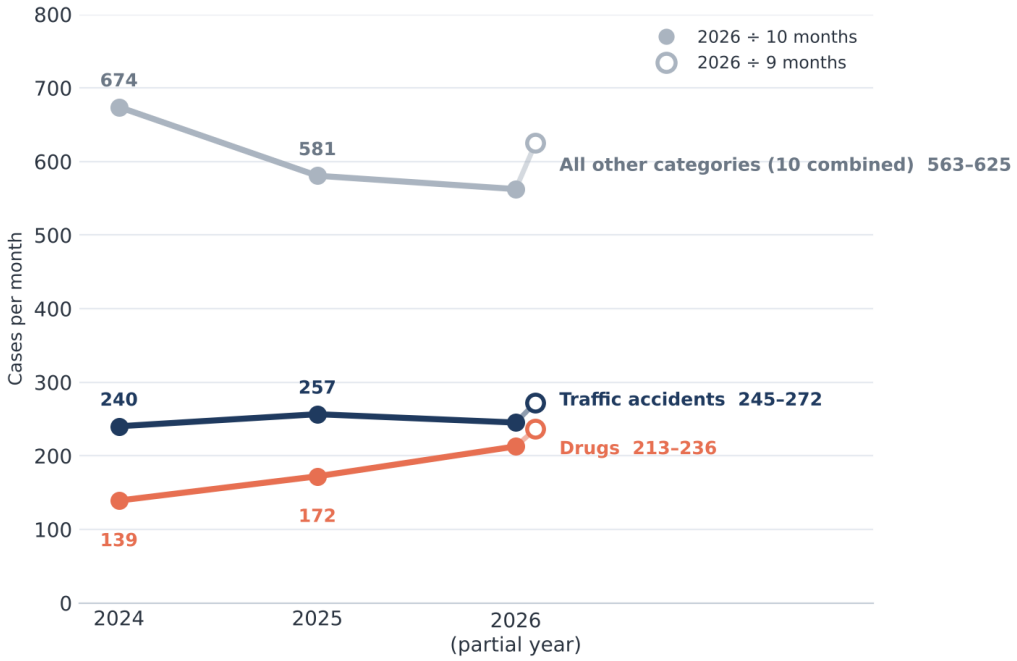


Figure 2. Cases per month. 2026 is shown under both cutoffs (filled = ten months, hollow = nine months). Drugs rises while the other ten categories combined fall from 2024 to 2025.

What the data cannot show

The counts say nothing about severity or casualties. The Land Transport Act was announced as ratified on 31 August 2026 and comes into force 30 days after ratification and publication in the Government Gazette, so it overlaps at most the final weeks of the 2026 data and cannot explain these counts.

3. Categories that declined

Observation From 2024 to 2025, every category other than drugs and traffic accidents fell. The largest absolute falls were domestic violence (−301), theft (−282) and sexual offences (−183). In 2026, the monthly rates of sexual offences, robbery and counterfeit and forgery (and cheque bounce, on counts of 6 and 2) kept falling under either cutoff. Domestic violence fell by almost half in 2025 (−45.8%; 55 → 30 a month) and stayed near that level in 2026 (27 to 30). Vandalism and assault fell in 2025 and then rose above their 2025 monthly rates under either cutoff; relative to 2024 they are between 6% below and 9% above, depending on the cutoff.

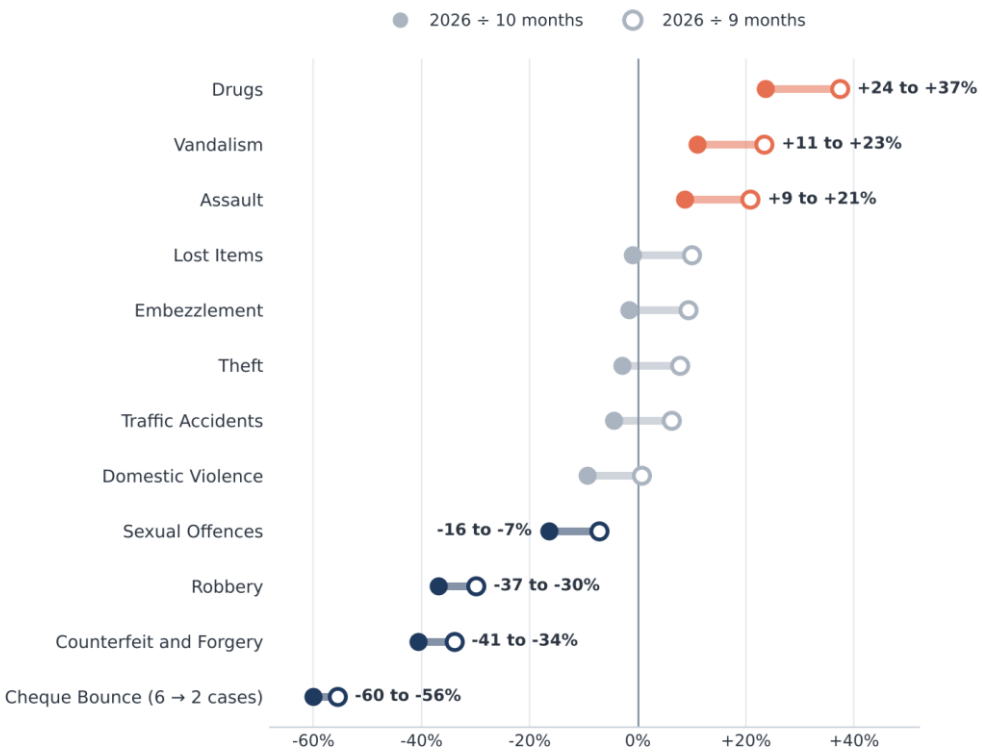


Figure 3. Change in monthly case rate, 2026 vs 2025, under both cutoffs (filled = ten months, hollow = nine months). Orange: rises under both; navy: falls under both; grey: the direction depends on the cutoff.

Interpretation Seven categories keep the same direction under either cutoff: drugs, vandalism and assault rise, and sexual offences, robbery, counterfeit and forgery and cheque bounce fall. For the other five (theft, traffic accidents, lost items, embezzlement and domestic violence), whether the 2026 rate is above or below 2025 depends on the cutoff.

> **What the data cannot show**
> A fall in recorded cases does not establish improved safety. Domestic violence and sexual offences can be under-reported (a general point these data do not measure), so a fall can reflect changes in reporting, classification or recording as well as fewer incidents. Nothing in the supplied evidence links any reform to these categories.

4. The overall picture

Observation Drugs and traffic accidents together added 593 cases in 2025 while the other ten categories lost 1,121. Excluding those two, cases fell from 8,089 to 6,968 (−13.9%). For all categories combined, the 2026 monthly rate is 1.1% above 2025 on the ten-month cutoff and 12.3% above on the nine-month cutoff.

Interpretation Recorded cases fell between 2024 and 2025, but “crime fell” is too strong a summary: the mix is shifting toward drug cases, and the total combines offences with accidents and lost-property reports. In 2026 the total monthly rate is above 2025 under both cutoffs (it would fall below only if the data covered more than about 10.1 months), but how far above depends on the cutoff.

Legislative and news context

The supplied evidence gives useful context, but none of it can test whether a law changed the counts, because the statistics are annual and the evidence items are single events.

Item	What it establishes	What it cannot establish
Prevention of Gang and Other Serious Offences Act (7/2025)	Passed by the Majlis on 15 May 2025; presidency press release dated 25 May 2025 announces ratification and states the Act has been gazetted and is in legal effect (no separate commencement date).	Any effect on case counts. 2025 mixes pre- and post-Act months, and 2026 is only partly recorded.
Land Transport Act	Press release dated 31 August 2026 announces ratification. Comes into force 30 days after ratification and publication in the Government Gazette; repeals Act No. 5/2009 and the Pedestrian Act (70/78). No law number or commencement date is given.	Any effect on the counts: it comes into force at or after the end of the data period. evidence.xlsx gives 1 October 2026 and Law No. 16/2026; neither could be verified.
Three 2026 headlines listed in evidence.xlsx (a drug arrest, a motorbike crash, a hacking theft)	That such cases are reported, if the headlines are accurate. They could not be verified in this audit, and the motorbike item cites the see.mv drugs page.	A trend. Each is a single case.

Explaining a change needs counts dated finely enough to fall before and after an event. What this evidence supports is a set of hypotheses to test, not explanations.

Conclusion

Recorded cases fell 4.2% from 2024 to 2025, because falls in ten categories outweighed rises in drugs and traffic accidents. Drug cases are the clearest increase and continue to rise in 2026 under either cutoff. Sexual offences, robbery and counterfeit and forgery are the clearest continuing declines. For the remaining categories, and for traffic accidents in particular, the 2026 comparison cannot be settled until the end of the 2026 data is known. These are changes in recorded cases: the data cannot show whether underlying offending, police activity or recording practices changed, or whether either law affected the counts.

Limitations and next steps

- The exact end of the 2026 data is not recorded, so every 2026 comparison depends on the assumed cutoff.
- Only 36 values exist (12 categories × 3 years), one per category per year, with a partial final year.
- The measure is not defined (reports received versus cases attended), and categories mix offences with accidents and lost property.
- The supplied data contain no population, visitor, regional or monthly figures, so no rates per head and no seasonality. The police dashboard reportedly offers a month selector, which may resolve this.
- How the police compile or classify the figures could not be verified.

Suggested next steps

1. Confirm the exact end date of the 2026 data and state it in every chart and table.
2. Use the police dashboard's month selector (if available) to establish the 2026 cutoff and obtain monthly counts, then rebuild the analysis on them.
3. Record each category's definition and separate crimes from accident and lost-property reports.
4. Add population and visitor figures to compute rates per 100,000 residents.
5. Test specific hypotheses with dated data, for example monthly drug cases before and after May 2025.
6. Add the calculations behind this report to the notebook; the supplied script report_analysis.py reproduces every figure.

Sources

- Case counts: Maldives Police Service crime statistics (police.gov.mv/crime-statistics), as supplied in MALDIVES_CRIMESTATS_2426.xlsx (created 25 October 2026; the notes say "up to Oct"). The dashboard figures themselves could not be re-checked in this audit.
- Presidency of the Maldives, press release on the Prevention of Gang and Other Serious Offences Act, 25 May 2025 (Ref. 2025-461): presidency.gov.mv/Press/Article/33786
- Presidency of the Maldives, press release on the Land Transport Act, 31 August 2026 (Ref. 2026-519): presidency.gov.mv/Press/Article/37273
- Added during audit: Plus.mv, "President Muizzu Ratifies Anti-Gang Legislation", 25 May 2025 (plus.mv/?p=127732), for the 15 May 2025 passage date.
- News headlines in evidence.xlsx (see.mv, english.sun.mv) and the mfr.mv road-safety opinion piece: not verified or reviewed.